

or several others can listen instantly. The service connects mobile phone users with each other within seconds.

Currently, PTT users have to belong to the same mobile operator's (carrier's) network in order to talk to each other. PTT commonly does not use up the regular airtime minutes that are available for general voice calls; it uses the GPRS connection, on which the amount of data transmitted is billed—not the minutes of conversation.

The Motorola and Nokia versions of PTT are based on 2.5G packet-switched networks (CDMA by Motorola, GPRS by Nokia) and use the SIP and RTP protocols. These particular versions of PTT are called "Push to Talk over Cellular", which is abbreviated "PoC". The Open Mobile Alliance is defining PoC as part of the IP Multimedia Subsystem, and a first version of OMA PoC standard was finalised in first half of 2005. A pre-standard version of PoC is also defined by the industry consortium made up of Motorola, Nokia, Ericsson, Siemens AG, AT&T Wireless, and Cingular Wireless with the aim of creating a commercial offering enabling inter-operability between vendors.